

KARAOKE LAB

User Manual · Version 1.0

Karaoke video maker for Windows and macOS

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1 Welcome

Karaoke Lab turns any song into a professional karaoke video. You bring the song and the lyrics; Karaoke Lab helps you time every word, styles the lyrics with a smooth colour wipe, adds animated backgrounds, a countdown and a title card, and renders a Full HD video ready for YouTube, a TV or a karaoke night.

Everything runs on your own computer. Songs, lyrics and videos are not uploaded anywhere. The only things that use the internet are the optional online features: lyrics search, YouTube import, stock video backgrounds and the first download of the auto-sync speech model.

What you can do

- Import a song from a file or a YouTube link, or a music video as the source.
- Find lyrics online, or paste your own. Hebrew and other right-to-left languages are detected automatically.
- Sync the words automatically with built-in speech recognition, or tap them in by hand with the keyboard.
- Fine-tune every word on a Premiere-style timeline.
- Remove the vocals from any song to create a playback, with an optional quiet guide vocal.
- Style the lyrics: fonts, colours, stroke, shadow, wipe direction, positions and per-word colours.
- Add duets, countdowns, title cards with 20 animations, logos, 20 video filters and animated backgrounds.
- Render MP4 video in Full HD, or export .ass and .lrc subtitle files.
- Show the video on a TV with Chromecast.

2 Installing and updating

Windows

1. Download **Karaoke-Lab-Setup.exe** from the download page.
2. Run it. If Windows SmartScreen shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** and then **Run anyway**.
3. Karaoke Lab installs and opens. A shortcut is added to the desktop and the Start menu.

macOS

1. Download the DMG that matches your Mac: **Karaoke-Lab-mac-arm64.dmg** for Apple Silicon (M1, M2, M3, M4) or **Karaoke-Lab-mac-x64.dmg** for Intel Macs. To check, open the Apple menu and choose **About This Mac**.
2. Open the DMG and drag **Karaoke Lab** into **Applications**.
3. The first time, macOS may say the app cannot be checked. Open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway**. You only need to do this once.

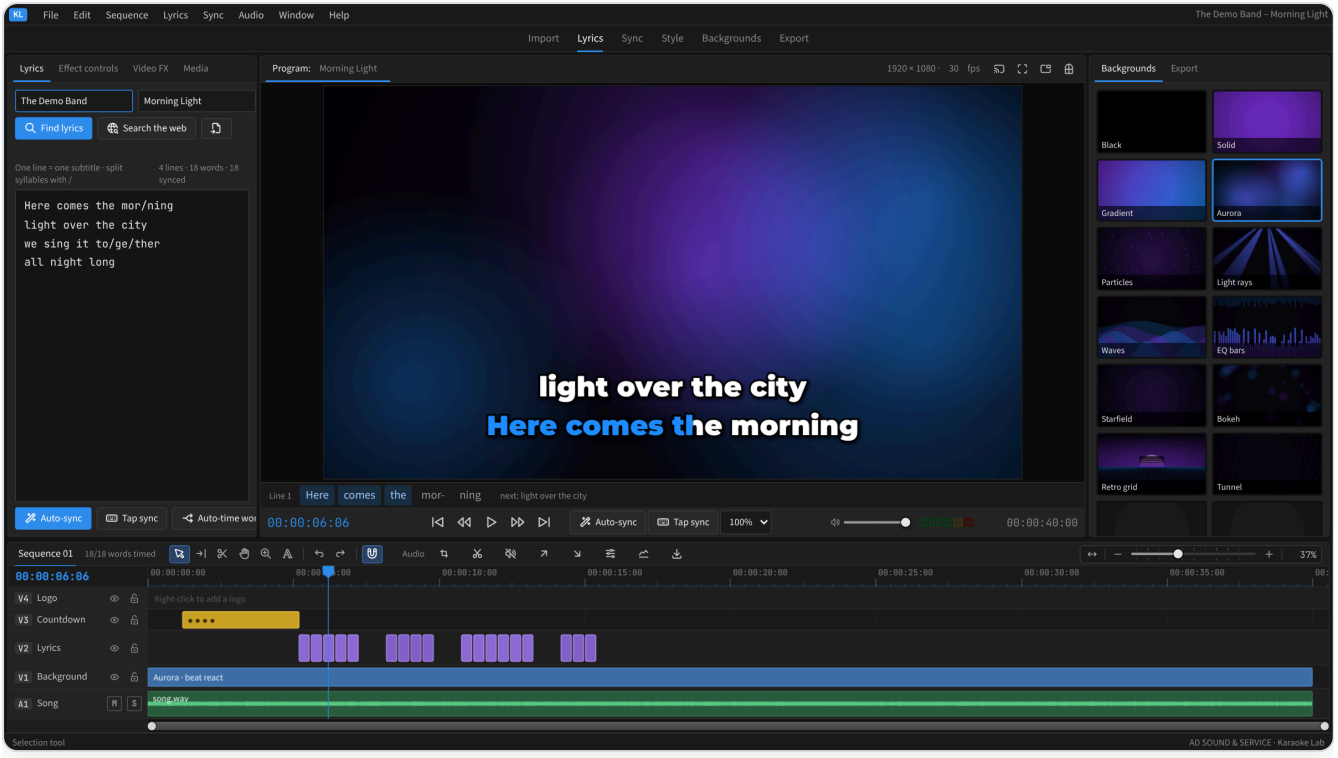
Updates

Karaoke Lab checks for new versions when it starts. On Windows the update downloads in the background and installs when you restart the app. On a Mac, Karaoke Lab tells you about the new version and downloads the new DMG for you. You can also check at any time with **Help → Check for updates…**

> **Everything is included**
> The YouTube downloader, the vocal-removal engine, the fonts and the icons are all built into the app. There is nothing else to install.

3 The workspace

The Karaoke Lab window is laid out like a video editor. The picture below names each part.



The Karaoke Lab workspace.

Area	What it does
Menu bar (top left)	File, Edit, Sequence, Lyrics, Sync, Audio, Window and Help.
Workspace tabs (top centre)	Import, Lyrics, Sync, Style, Backgrounds and Export jump straight to the panels for each stage of the job.
Left panel	Four tabs: **Lyrics** (song title, artist and lyrics text), **Effect controls** (all styling), **Video FX** (filters) and **Media** (song, YouTube, vocal removal, video clip and logo).
Program monitor (centre)	The live picture, exactly as it will be rendered. Under it: the sync strip showing the words of the current line, and the transport bar.
Right panel	**Backgrounds** (animated presets, images and stock video) and **Export** (render video, subtitle files, project).
Timeline (bottom)	All tracks over time: V4 Logo, V3 Countdown, V2 Lyrics, V1 Background, A1 Song and, after vocal removal, A2 Vocal.
Status bar	The active tool and hints, for example how many words are selected.

Transport bar

From left to right: the current time, go to start, back 5 seconds, play/pause, forward 5 seconds, go to end, **Auto-sync**, **Tap sync**, playback speed, the monitor volume slider with its LED level meter, and the song length.

The LED meter shows the level of the left and right channels: green is normal, yellow is loud and red is close to clipping. It shows the level of the song itself, so it still moves when the volume slider is low.

4 Your first karaoke video

This is the quickest way from a song to a finished video. Each step has its own chapter later in this manual.

1. **Import the song.** **File** → **Import song…** (`Ctrl+I`), or paste a YouTube link in **Media** → **From YouTube**.
2. **Get the lyrics.** In the **Lyrics** tab type the artist and the title and click **Find lyrics**, or paste the lyrics into the big text box. One line of text becomes one subtitle line.
3. **Make a playback** (optional). **Media** → **Create playback** → **Separate vocals** removes the singer's voice.
4. **Sync.** Click **Auto-sync** and then **Start**. When it finishes, play the song and check the words. Fix anything that's off on the timeline, or tap it in by hand with **Tap sync**.
5. **Style it.** Choose a background in the right panel, and fonts and colours in **Effect controls**.
6. **Render.** Open **Export** in the right panel and click **Render video**. The video plays through once in real time and is then saved as an MP4.

> **Tip**
> Save your project with `Ctrl+S` as you go. A project keeps the lyrics, every word's timing and all your styling, so you can come back to it later.

5 Importing the song

From a file

Use **File → Import song…** (`Ctrl+I`) or the **Import song** button in the **Media** tab. MP3, WAV, M4A, OGG and FLAC all work. The waveform appears on the A1 track of the timeline.

From YouTube

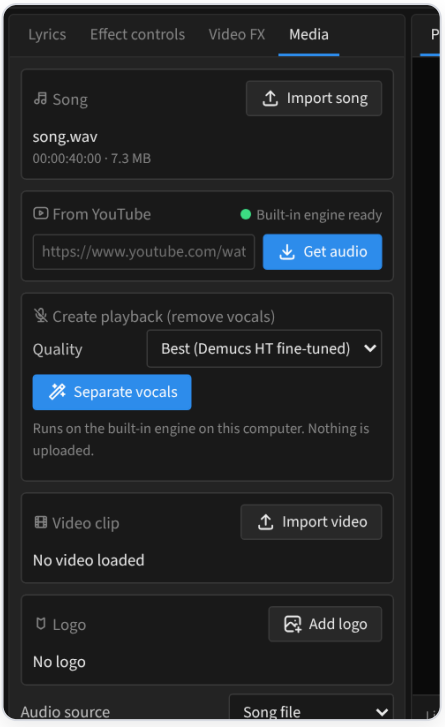
Paste a YouTube link into **Media → From YouTube** and click **Get audio**. Karaoke Lab downloads the audio in the best quality available and loads it as the song. The title and artist are filled in from the video when possible. The green dot shows that the built-in engine is ready.

From a video

File → Import video… loads a music video. Its picture can be used as the background and its sound as the song.

Importing lyrics files

File → Import lyrics (.lrc / .txt)… loads plain text, or an LRC file with its timing.

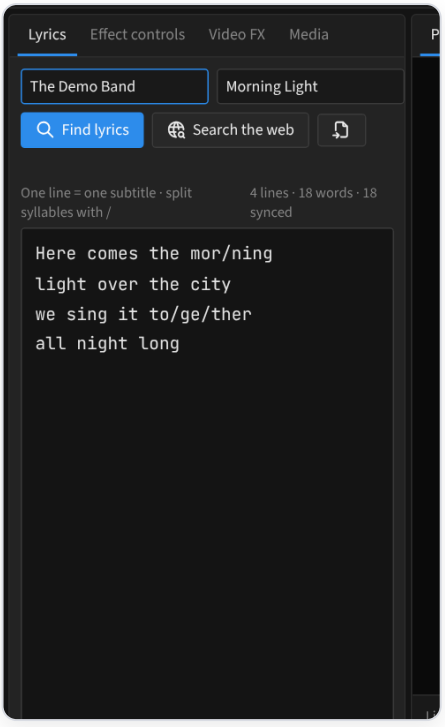


The Media tab.

> **Copyright**
> Only use songs and videos that you have the right to use. Downloading from YouTube is meant for content you own or that is licensed for this use.

6 Lyrics

The **Lyrics** tab holds the song's artist, title and lyrics. The artist and title are also used for the title card and the file names.



The Lyrics tab.

Finding lyrics

- **Find lyrics** searches open lyrics databases by artist and title, trying several spellings, and fills in the text.
- **Search the web** opens a built-in browser with a web search for the song. Select the lyrics on any page and click **Use selected text as lyrics**, or **Use whole page text**. The text is cleaned up for you.

Writing the lyrics

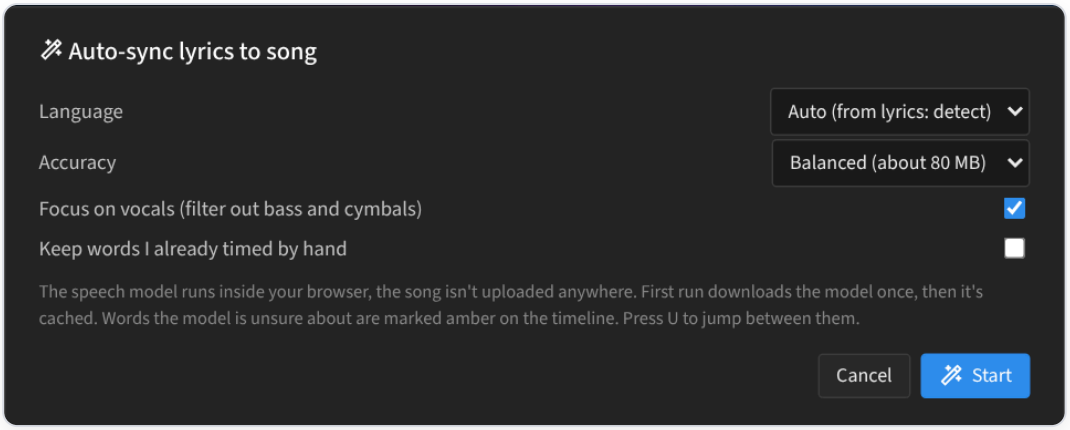
- Each line in the box is one subtitle line on screen.
- Split a word into syllables with a slash: `mor/ning`. Each syllable is timed and wiped separately, which looks great on long sung notes.
- Empty lines are ignored, so you can leave gaps between verses.
- Hebrew, Arabic and other right-to-left lines are detected automatically and wipe from right to left.

Editing the text keeps the timing of words that didn't change.

7 Syncing the words

Syncing gives every word a start and an end time. Karaoke Lab offers two ways, and you can mix them.

Auto-sync



The Auto-sync window.

Click **Auto-sync** (or **Sync** → **Auto-sync lyrics to song…**, `Ctrl+Shift+A`). A speech-recognition model listens to the song and matches what it hears to your lyrics.

- **Language**: leave it on **Auto**, or pick the song's language.
- **Accuracy**: Fast, Balanced or Best. Better accuracy uses a bigger model and takes longer.
- **Focus on vocals** filters out bass and cymbals so the voice is clearer to the model. If you already separated the vocals, the vocal track is used automatically.
- **Keep words I already timed by hand** leaves your manual work untouched.

The first run downloads the model once; after that it works offline. Words the model is unsure about are coloured amber on the timeline. Press `U` to jump to the next unsure word and check it.

Tap sync

Tap sync is the classic karaoke way: you play the song and press a key on every word.

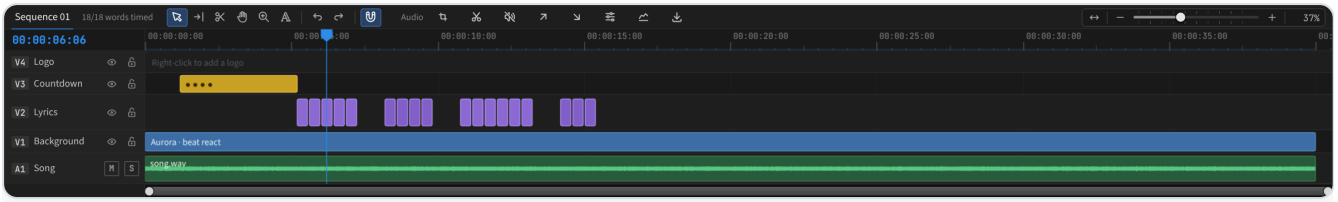
1. Click **Tap sync** or press `S` to arm it. The next word to tap is highlighted in the sync strip under the monitor.
2. Play the song. **Hold** `Space` when a word starts and **release** it when the word ends. Each press times one word or syllable.
3. Made a mistake? Press `Backspace`: it steps back one word and rewinds 2.5 seconds so you can tap it again.
4. Press `S` again to disarm.

> **Tip: slow it down**
> Set the playback speed to 75% (**Sync** → **Sync speed 75%**) for fast songs. The timing is still recorded at the real speed.

Auto-time words inside lines

If you only know when each line starts and ends, **Lyrics → Auto-time words inside timed lines** spreads the words of each line evenly between its start and end.

8 The timeline



The timeline, with the tools bar on top and the zoom control on the right.

Tracks

Track	Contents
V4 Logo	Your logo. Drag its edges to show it for only part of the song.
V3 Countdown	Countdown clips (dots or numbers) and the title card.
V2B Lyrics 2	The second singer's words, when you add a duet track.
V2 Lyrics	One purple clip for each word or syllable.
V1 Background	The background for the whole song.
A1 Song	The song waveform, or the playback after vocal removal.
A2 Vocal	The separated vocal, after vocal removal.

Each video track has two buttons in its header. The **eye** turns the track off in the monitor and in the rendered video. The **lock** protects the track from accidental edits; clicking a locked track only moves the playhead. Audio tracks have **M** (mute) and **S** (solo), which affect both what you hear and the rendered video.

Tools

Tool	Use
Selection `V`	Select, move and trim word clips. Drag a word's edges to change its start or end.
Track select forward `A`	Drag a word and everything after it moves together.
Razor `C`	Click a word to split it in two.
Hand `H`	Drag to scroll the timeline.
Zoom `Z`	Click to zoom in, Alt+click to zoom out.
Type `T`	Click a word to edit its text.
Snapping `N`	Word edges snap to neighbouring words and the playhead.
Undo / Redo	The two arrow buttons, or `Ctrl+Z` and `Ctrl+Shift+Z`.

Moving around

- Click the ruler to move the playhead. **Double-click the blue playhead flag** to zoom to 50% around it.
- The zoom control on the right has fit-to-song, minus, a slider, plus and a percentage you can click and type into. The slider always zooms around the playhead.
- The scrollbar under the tracks works like Premiere: drag the middle to scroll, drag its round ends to zoom, double-click it to fit the whole song, or use the mouse wheel over it.
- `Ctrl` + mouse wheel over the tracks zooms at the mouse position. `=` and `-` zoom in and out, `\` fits the whole song.

9 Editing words and lines

Selecting several words

- Drag a rectangle across empty space on the Lyrics track to select all the words inside it.
- `Ctrl` +click or `Shift` +click adds or removes single words. `Ctrl+A` selects every timed word.
- Drag any selected word and all selected words move together; the others stay in place. `,` and `.` nudge them by 10 ms (with Shift, 100 ms).
- `Esc` clears the selection. `Delete` clears the timing of the selected words.

Fine timing

With a word selected, `,` and `.` nudge it by 10 ms (Shift = 100 ms). Add `Alt` to move only its start, or `Ctrl+Alt` to move only its end.

Copy and paste words

Select a word and press `Ctrl+C` (or right-click → **Copy word**). Move the playhead and press `Ctrl+V` to paste it there, or right-click on the Lyrics track → **Paste here** / **Paste after this word**. Pasted words keep their length and colours.

Editing text in the sync strip

Click a word in the sync strip under the monitor to edit it. Type new text and press Enter (a space splits it into two words), or use **Delete word**, **Join with previous** or **Delete whole line**.

Word colours

Double-click a word on the timeline to give it its own colours before and after it is sung. Apply them to **This word**, the **Whole line**, or the **Same word everywhere** in the song.

Moving, scaling and rotating a line on screen

Click a line of lyrics in the program monitor. A box with handles appears: drag inside it to move the line, drag a corner to scale, and drag the round handle above it to rotate (hold Shift to snap the angle). Choose whether the change applies to **This line** or **All lines**.

10 Duets: the Lyrics 2 track



A duet: the second singer's line appears in pink above the main singer's lines.

A duet track holds a second singer's words, with their own colours.

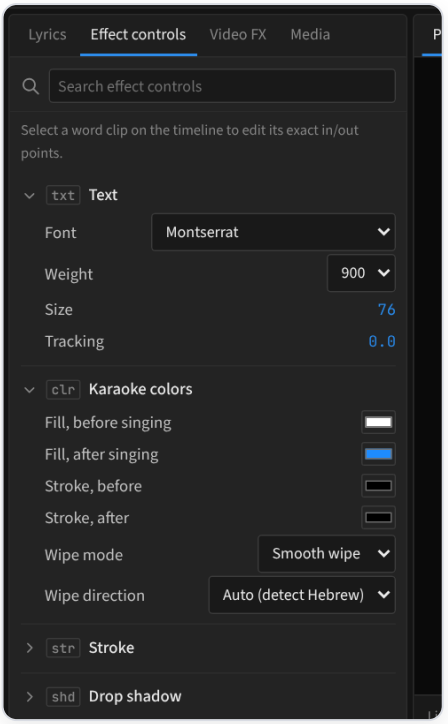
1. Add it with **Sequence** → **Add Lyrics 2 track (duet)**, or right-click the Lyrics track.
2. Two tabs appear in the Lyrics panel: **Lyrics 1** and **Lyrics 2 · Duet**. Type the second singer's lines in Lyrics 2.
3. Sync them the same way. Tap sync, auto-sync and all editing tools work on the track you have selected: click its tab, or click its lane on the timeline.
4. Set its colours and position in **Effect controls** → **Lyrics 2 · Duet**: next to Lyrics 1, at the top of the screen, or at the bottom.

The duet is included in the rendered video and in the .ass subtitle file.

11 Styling the lyrics

All styling lives in **Effect controls** in the left panel. The categories start closed; click a heading to open it. The search box at the top finds any setting as you type, for example "shadow" or "צבע".

Category	Settings
Text	Font, weight, size, tracking.
Karaoke colors	Fill and stroke colours before and after singing, wipe mode, wipe direction (per song).
Stroke	Outline width.
Drop shadow	Colour, opacity, softness, offset.
Border box	A box behind each line: colour, opacity, padding, rounded corners.
Layout	Lines on screen, line order, position, margin, spacing.
Lyrics 2 · Duet	Colours and position of the duet singer.
Line timing	How early a line appears, how long it stays, fades.
Countdown, **Title card**, **Background**	See the next chapters.



Effect controls.

Line order

Next line on top keeps the upcoming line above and the line being sung below, as in most karaoke systems. You can switch to the classic order in Layout.

Fonts

Karaoke Lab includes Latin display fonts (Montserrat, Anton, Oswald, Bebas Neue, Poppins, Roboto and others) and 18 Hebrew fonts, marked "עברית" in the font list. All fonts are built in, so they work offline and look the same in the rendered video.

> **Tip**
>
> **Save as default style** at the bottom of Effect controls uses your current look for every new project.

12 Countdown and title card

Countdown

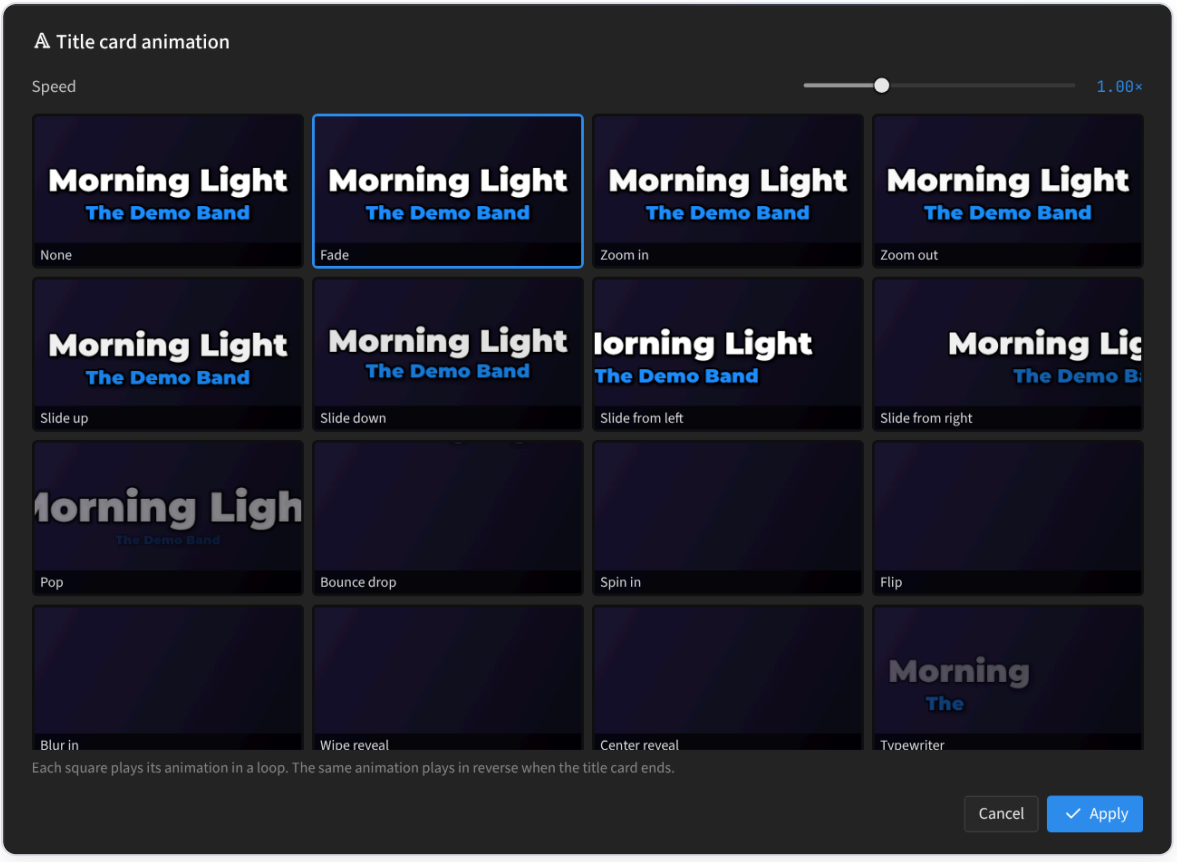
A countdown appears before the first line and, if you want, after long instrumental breaks. In **Effect controls** → **Countdown** choose **Dots** or **Digits**, the colour, outline, size, count and position.

- Countdowns appear as yellow clips on the V3 track. Drag them to move them freely, or drag their edges to change their length.
- Right-click V3 to **Add countdown** anywhere, delete one, or **Reset countdowns to automatic**.
- In the monitor, drag the countdown to place it anywhere on screen.

Title card

The title card shows the song title and the artist at the start of the video. Turn it on in **Effect controls** → **Title card**.

- It appears as a grey clip on V3. Drag its edges to make it longer or shorter, or drag the middle to move it. Right-click → **Reset title card length** returns to the automatic length.
- **Double-click the title card** to open the animation gallery. Every animation plays live in its square with your own title. Pick one, set the speed (0.25× to 3×), and click **Apply**. The same animation plays in reverse when the title card ends.



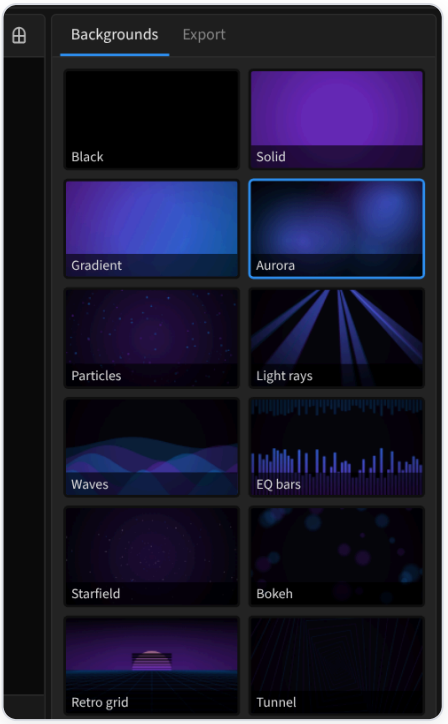
The title card animation gallery.

The 20 animations: Fade, Zoom in, Zoom out, Slide up, Slide down, Slide from left, Slide from right, Pop, Bounce drop, Spin in, Flip, Blur in, Wipe reveal, Center reveal, Typewriter, Words rise, Words cascade, Neon flicker, Glitch and Stretch, plus None.

13 Backgrounds

The **Backgrounds** tab in the right panel holds animated presets. Click one to use it, then fine-tune it in **Effect controls → Background**: colours, speed, intensity and **React to the beat**, which makes the background pulse with the music.

- Black
- Solid
- Gradient
- Aurora
- Particles
- Light rays
- Waves
- EQ bars
- Starfield
- Bokeh
- Retro grid
- Tunnel



Background presets.

Images and videos

Use your own picture or video file as the background, or the music video you imported.

Stock video

Search free stock videos from Pexels right inside the app and use them as backgrounds. This needs a free Pexels API key, which you paste in once. Pexels videos are free to use, including commercially.



Light rays



Retro grid

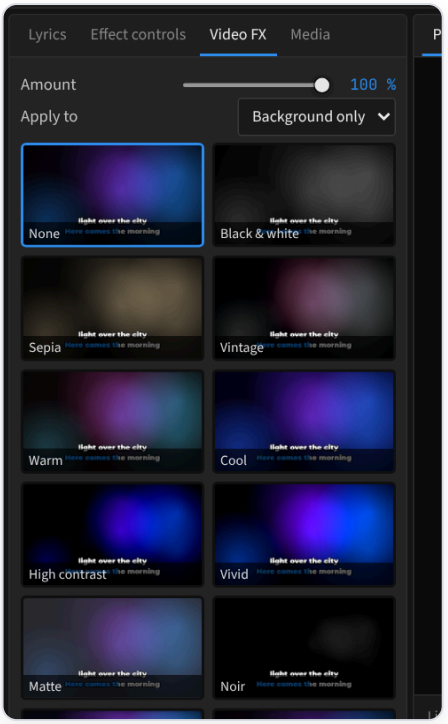
14 Video FX

The **Video FX** tab puts a filter over the video. Each square shows the current frame with its filter, so you can compare them at a glance.

- Click a filter to use it. Click it again, or choose **None**, to remove it.
- **Amount** sets how strong the filter is.
- **Apply to**: **Background only** keeps the lyrics clean and readable; **Whole picture** filters the lyrics too.

The 20 filters: Black & white, Sepia, Vintage, Warm, Cool, High contrast, Vivid, Matte, Noir, Dreamy glow, Soft focus, Invert, Color cycle, Neon, Teal & orange, Film grain, RGB split, Pixelate, Duotone and Mirror.

> **Performance**
> Dreamy glow, Soft focus and RGB split use the most computer power. On an older computer, test a short render first.



Video FX.

15 Logo

Add your logo with **File → Import logo…**, the **Add logo** button in the Media tab, or right-click the V4 track. The **Logo editor** opens first:

- **Remove background**: **Auto (edge color)** removes the colour around the edges of the image, or **Pick color** lets you choose the colour to erase. Adjust **Tolerance** and **Edge softness**.
- **Frame**: None, Line, Rounded, Circle, Plate or Neon, with colour, width, padding and corner radius.
- Check the preview and click **Apply**.

In the program monitor, drag the logo to move it and drag a corner to resize it. In the Media tab set its opacity, size and position exactly. On the V4 track, drag the logo clip's edges to show it for only part of the song, or right-click for **Show for the whole song**, **Start the logo here** or **End the logo here**.

16 Audio tools and vocal removal

Create a playback (remove vocals)

In **Media** → **Create playback** choose the quality and click **Separate vocals**. The built-in Demucs engine splits the song into the music (playback) and the voice. It runs entirely on your computer; a 4-minute song takes a few minutes, depending on the computer.

When it finishes, the playback goes on A1 and the voice on A2. A mix selector appears in the transport bar, so you can choose what you hear. The audio of the rendered video is set separately in the Export panel.

Mix	Result
Original	The song with the singer.
Playback + guide	The playback with the voice turned down, so a singer can follow it.
Playback only	Music only.

Editing the audio

Mark a range with `I` (in) and `O` (out), or drag across the audio track. Then use the Audio menu or the audio buttons on the timeline bar:

- **Trim to selection** keeps only the marked part. **Delete selection** (`Shift+Delete`) removes it and closes the gap.
- **Silence**, **Fade in**, **Fade out**, **Gain…** and **Normalize to -1 dB**.

Word timings move with the audio when you cut it, and every audio edit can be undone. Export the edited audio as WAV or MP3, or the separated vocal as WAV, from the Audio menu.

17 The program monitor and Chromecast

Monitor views

- **Maximize** (`` ` ``): the monitor fills the window.
- **Floating** (`Shift+`` `): a floating window you can move and resize freely.
- **Separate window** (**Window** → **Monitor in separate window**): drag it to a second screen or a projector and make it full screen.
- **Safe margins** (**Window** → **Toggle safe margins**) shows the TV-safe area.

Cast to a TV

1. Make sure the TV with Chromecast (or Google TV) is on, and on the same Wi-Fi network as your computer.
2. Click the **Cast** button in the monitor header. Karaoke Lab searches the network and lists the TVs it finds.
3. Click your TV. The picture and sound are sent to it in 720p.
4. To stop, click the Cast button and then the TV's name.

Mute this computer while casting is on by default, because the TV plays a few seconds behind the computer and you'll want the sound from the TV only.

> **Windows firewall**
>
> The first time you cast, Windows may ask whether Karaoke Lab may use the network. Click **Allow**; otherwise the TV can't receive the video.

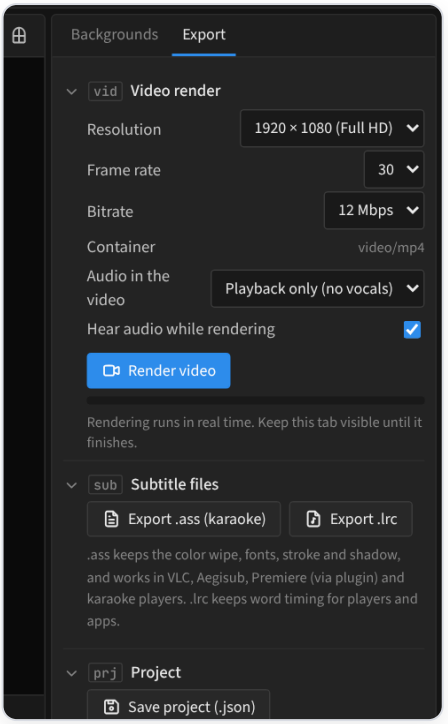
18 Rendering and exporting

Render video

Open **Export** in the right panel (or press `Ctrl+M`):

- **Resolution**: 1920 × 1080 (Full HD) or 1280 × 720.
- **Frame rate**: 25, 30 or 60.
- **Bitrate**: 8, 12 or 20 Mbps. Higher means better quality and bigger files.
- **Audio in the video**: Playback only, Original, or Playback + guide vocal.
- **Hear audio while rendering**: turn off for a silent render.

Click **Render video**. Rendering runs in real time: a 4-minute song takes 4 minutes. Keep Karaoke Lab visible on screen until it finishes, then save the MP4 file.



Export panel.

Subtitle files

- **.ass (karaoke)** keeps the colour wipe, fonts, stroke and shadow. It works in VLC, Aegisub, karaoke players and video editors.
- **.lrc** keeps the word timing for music players and apps.

19 Projects, saving and undo

- **Save project** (`Ctrl+S`) saves everything (lyrics, timing, styling, countdowns, logo and effects) to a .json project file. The first time, you choose where; after that `Ctrl+S` saves to the same file.
- **Save project as…** (`Ctrl+Shift+S`) saves a copy under a new name.
- **Open project** (`Ctrl+O`). Audio and video files aren't stored inside the project, so import the song again after opening it.
- Karaoke Lab also keeps your current work automatically, so it's still there after a restart.
- When you close the app, it asks whether to save the project first: **Save**, **Don't save** or **Cancel**.

Undo

`Ctrl+Z` undoes and `Ctrl+Shift+Z` or `Ctrl+Y` redoes, on any keyboard layout, including Hebrew. Undo covers every change: words and timing, styling, backgrounds, countdowns, the logo, filters, line positions and audio edits. On a Mac use `⌘` instead of Ctrl.

20 Keyboard shortcuts

Press `F1` in the app to see this list at any time. On a Mac, use `⌘` for Ctrl.

Playback	
`Space`	Play / pause (or tap a word when tap sync is armed)
`J` `K` `L`	Back 5 s / pause / forward 5 s
`←` `→`	One frame back / forward (Shift = 1 second)
`Home` `End`	Go to start / end
Sync	
`S`	Arm / disarm tap sync
Hold `Space`	While armed: press when the word starts, release when it ends
`Backspace`	While armed: step back one word and rewind 2.5 s
`Ctrl+Shift+A`	Auto-sync
`U`	Jump to the next unsure word
Editing	
`,` `.`	Nudge selected words 10 ms (Shift = 100 ms)
`Alt+,` `Alt+.`	Nudge only the start
`Ctrl+Alt+,` `Ctrl+Alt+.`	Nudge only the end
`Delete`	Clear timing of the selected word(s)
`Ctrl+C` `Ctrl+V`	Copy a word / paste it at the playhead
`Ctrl+A` · `Esc`	Select all words · clear the selection
`Ctrl+Z` · `Ctrl+Shift+Z`	Undo · redo
Timeline	
`V` `A` `C` `H` `Z` `T`	Selection, track select forward, razor, hand, zoom, type
`N`	Snapping on / off
`=` `-` `\`	Zoom in / out / fit the song
Double-click the playhead	Zoom 50% around the playhead
`I` `O`	Mark in / out for audio edits
Files and windows	
`Ctrl+S` · `Ctrl+Shift+S` · `Ctrl+O`	Save · save as · open project

`Ctrl+I` · `Ctrl+M`	Import song · render video
`` ` `` · `Shift+` `	Maximize monitor · floating monitor
`F1`	Keyboard shortcuts

21 Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Find lyrics finds nothing	Check the spelling of the artist and title, or use **Search the web** and take the lyrics from any site.
Auto-sync is slow or stops	Choose a lower accuracy. The first run needs internet to download the model once.
Some words are synced in the wrong place	Press `U` to jump between unsure words and drag them into place, or re-tap the line with tap sync. Run auto-sync again with **Keep words I already timed by hand**.
YouTube import fails	Check the internet connection and the link. The downloader updates itself once a day; restart Karaoke Lab and try again.
The TV isn't found for Cast	Make sure the TV and the computer are on the same Wi-Fi, and allow Karaoke Lab through the firewall. Some guest or office networks block casting.
Picture and sound on the TV are delayed	That's normal for Chromecast streaming. Keep **Mute this computer while casting** on and use the TV's sound.
The rendered video stutters	Keep Karaoke Lab visible on screen while rendering, close other heavy programs, choose 30 fps, or turn off heavy Video FX.
macOS says the app can't be opened	System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**.
Opened project has no sound	Projects don't contain the audio file. Import the song again.

About

Karaoke Lab · © AD SOUND & SERVICE. Lyrics search uses the open LRCLIB and lyrics.ovh databases. Vocal separation uses Demucs; YouTube import uses yt-dlp; auto-sync uses the Whisper speech model.